NICHOLAS LACOSTE

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, UHERO *2026 – Present*
Assistant Professor of Economics

EDUCATION

Tulane University *2021 – 2026*
Ph.D. Economics
Advisors: Profs. William Dodds, Katy Bergstrom, Augustine Denteh

Louisiana State University *2018 – 2019*
M.S. Data Analytics

Louisiana State University *2014 – 2018*
B.S. Economics
Concentration: Empirical Economic Analysis
Summa cum Laude · E.J. Ourso College of Business co-Valedictorian

RESEARCH FIELDS

Public Economics
Machine Learning and Non-Parametric Econometrics
Development Economics

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Katy Bergstrom, William Dodds, **Nicholas Lacoste**, and Juan Rios. Estimating the Welfare Cost of Labor Supply Frictions. *Journal of Public Economics, 2026.*

WORKING PAPERS

[1] **Nicholas Lacoste** and Zerah Farooq. "Optimal Audit Targeting with Machine Learning: Evidence from Pakistan." *(Job Market Paper)*

[2] Feng Chen, Douglas N. Harris, and **Nicholas Lacoste**. "Semiparametric Continuous Difference-in-Differences with Causal Forests: The Case of Charter School Effect Heterogeneity." *Under Review.*

[3] **Nicholas Lacoste**. "The Potential for Improved Implementation of Microfinance through AI-Driven Targeting."

WORKS IN PROGRESS

[1] **Nicholas Lacoste**. "On an Optimal Standard Deduction and its' Uses"

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tulane University
Instructor

· Introductory Microeconomics Spring 2026

Tulane University
Teaching Assistant

- Development Economics (Ph.D.) — Spring 2025
- Development Economics — Fall 2024
- Economics of Big Data — Spring 2024, Fall 2023
- Introductory Microeconomics — Spring 2024, Fall 2023
- Introductory Macroeconomics — Spring 2025, Fall 2024, Spring 2023, Fall 2022
- Intermediate Microeconomics — Fall 2022

Tulane University
Guest Lecturer

- Development Economics (Ph.D.) – *"Causal AI and Large Language Models"* — Spring 2025
- Empirical Methods for Political Economy – *"Machine Learning for Economists"* — Fall 2024

Certifications

- *Certificate in Pedagical Practice* – Tulane Center for Engaged Learning and Teaching — Spring 2025

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Tulane University
Research Assistant

- Professor William Dodds — August 2023 – December 2025
- Professor Katy Bergstrom — August 2023 – December 2025

Louisiana State University
Research Assistant

- Economics and Policy Research Group — August 2018 – May 2019

NON-ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Cognizant Technology Solutions — June 2019 – July 2021
Senior Associate Data Scientist

- Conducted econometric forecasting and high-dimensional optimization with emphasis on evolutionary algorithms.

CSRS, Inc. — May 2016 – August 2017
Intern to the Executive Office — *Baton Rouge, LA*

- Assisted with financial modeling, bond issuance analysis, and research on infrastructure and real estate development projects.

CONTRACTUAL RESEARCH

Microsoft Corporation — February 2020 – July 2021
Demand Management and Forecasting — *Redmond, WA*

- Designed forecasting models and planning frameworks for remote server demand.

General Electric Appliances — September 2019 – February 2020
Pricing and Sales Forecasting — *Louisville, KY*

- Developed optimal pricing algorithms and conducted price elasticity estimation and sales forecasting.

Hanesbrands, Inc. January 2019 – May 2019
Client Targeting and Forecasting *Remote*

· Constructed lifetime-value measures and autoregressive models for forecasting business-to-business sales.

Louisiana State University Athletics Department August 2018 – December 2018
Ticket Retention Modeling *Baton Rouge, LA*

· Applied discrete-choice modeling to predict season-ticket nonrenewal and created risk-scoring systems for targeted outreach.

HONORS, AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

J.E. Land Fund Grant	2025
Tulane University School of Liberal Arts Fellowship	2021 – 2026
Louisiana State University Medal as co-Valedictorian	2018
Econometrics Student of the Year: Louisiana State University	2018
Tiger Excellence Scholars Award	2014 – 2018

CONFERENCES AND INVITED LECTURES

2026

· International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF), Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA), University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, Texas Christian University, Georgia State University, Southeastern Louisiana University

2025

· National Tax Association (NTA), International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF), Connolly Alexander Institute for Data Science (CAIDS) "Lunch and Learn" Seminar, Tulane University Lunch Seminar Series (Fall and Spring)

2024

· Tulane University Lunch Seminar Series (Fall and Spring), Western Economic Association International (WEAI), Southern Economic Association (SEA), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND OUTREACH

Tulane Economics Ph.D. Program Recruitment Coordinator	2023
Chief Editor: *Tulane Economics Working Paper Series*	2023 – 2026
Fundraising Chair: Global Business Brigades LSU Chapter	2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Scripting Languages	R, Python, Stata, MATLAB, SAS
Query Languages & Databases	SQL/POSTGRES, Microsoft Azure, AWS
Visualization Software	Microsoft Power BI, Tableau
Other Relevant	LaTeX, Claude Code/Codex, Unix/Linux OS, Git/GitHub

OTHER INFORMATION

Citizenship: United States

Last updated: October 8, 2026